VIT BHOPAL

DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

NAME: TEJASWANI YADAV
REGISTRATION NO.: 25BAI10361

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INTRODUCTION:

As part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal, I was assigned the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. This project required me to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio demonstrating my understanding of digital tools, online identity, collaboration platforms, professional communication, and cybercrime awareness.

The portfolio is organized across five tasks, each mapping to one module of the course. All work has been documented in a GitHub repository and this report summarizes my approach, observations, and reflections for each task.

This project helped me realize that being digitally active is not the same as being digitally aware. Through each task, I developed practical skills that I will carry forward throughout my academic and professional life.

TASK 1 — DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS INFOGRAPHIC:

For this task I created a one-page infographic using Canva to help my batchmates understand what Digital Literacy means and why it matters.

My infographic covered five key topics — what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, email etiquette, and professional online presence. I chose a clean blue gradient design to make it visually appealing and easy to read.

The tool I used was Canva because it is free, browser-based, and has many professional templates. I had never used Canva for an infographic before so learning to replace template text while keeping the design clean was a new experience for me.

One thing I found interesting was how much information can be communicated through a single visual. Writing the same content as a paragraph would have been less engaging than presenting it as a designed infographic. This task made me realize the importance of visual communication in the digital world.

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INFOGRAPHIC:

TASK 2 — STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO:

For this task I set up my professional digital presence across three platforms — GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

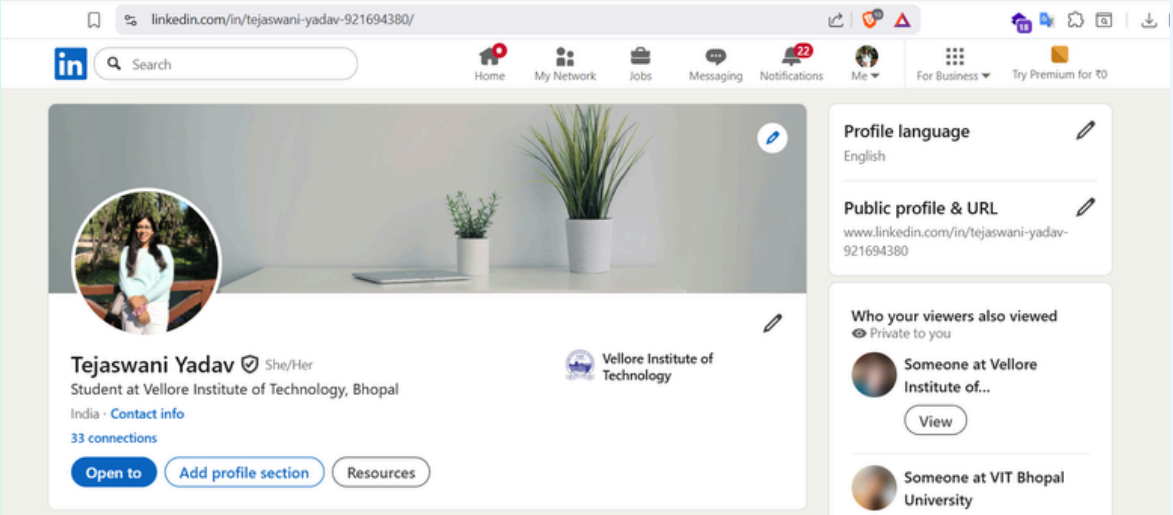
On GitHub I created a profile README repository that displays my name, branch, year, current learning goals, and future plans. This acts as a living portfolio that will grow as I learn more skills over the next four years.

On LinkedIn I filled in my Education section with my B.Tech AI and ML degree at VIT Bhopal with expected graduation in 2029. LinkedIn is used by recruiters and internship coordinators to find candidates, so having a complete profile early is important.

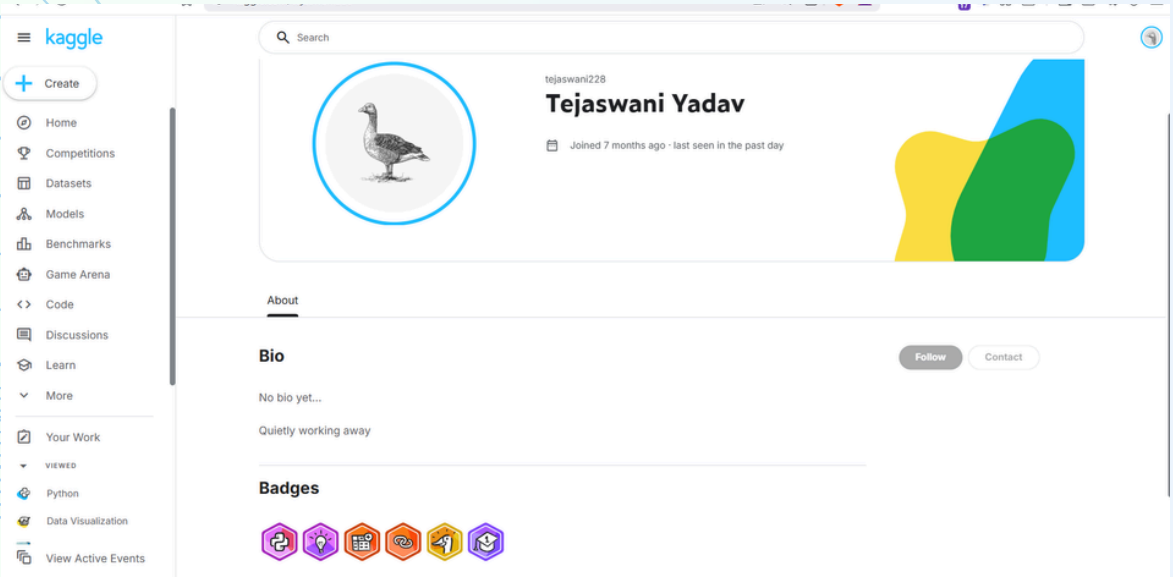
On Kaggle I created an account which I plan to use for data science competitions and ML practice datasets as I progress in my AI/ML journey.

This task made me realize that building a digital presence early in college gives you a head start. Most students only think about LinkedIn in their final year but by then it is too late to show growth over time. Starting now means my profile will reflect four years of genuine learning.

SCREENSHOTS:



--LinkedIn



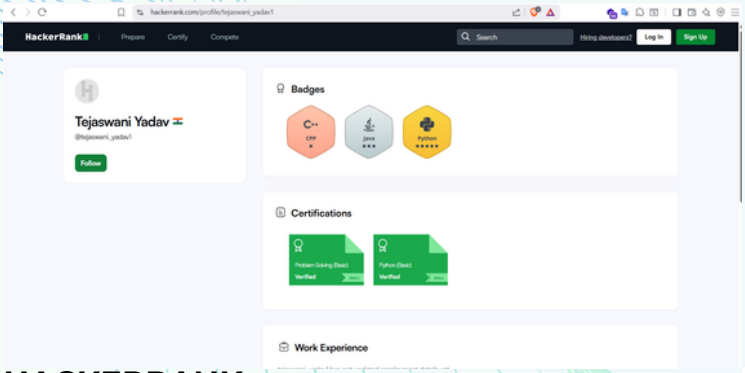
--Kaggle

TASK 3 — CODING AND COLLABORATION PLATFORMS:

For this task I explored two categories of digital tools — coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools.
For coding practice I used HackerRank where I have already completed multiple Python challenges and courses. HackerRank helps students practice programming in a structured way with instant feedback on correct and incorrect solutions. It is widely recognized by companies during hiring processes.

For collaboration I created a five question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz covers topics like what digital literacy means, strong passwords, cybercrime awareness, safe internet practices, and two factor authentication. I linked the form to a Google Sheet so responses can be tracked automatically.
What surprised me about Google Forms was how easy it is to collect and organize data from multiple people without any coding. This is a powerful tool for surveys, quizzes, and feedback collection in academic and professional settings.

These platforms will help me academically by giving me a place to practice coding regularly and collaborate with teammates on assignments without needing to meet physically.



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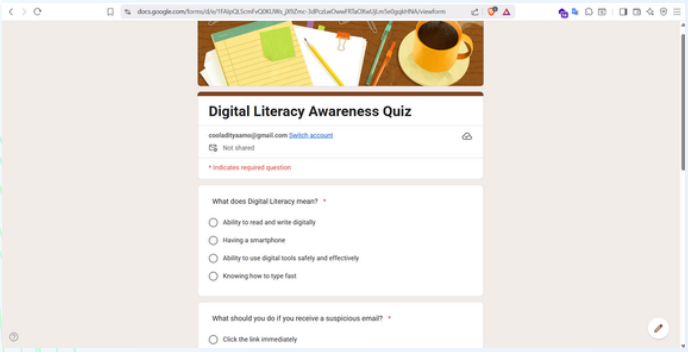
GOOGLE FORM



TASK 4 — PROFESSIONAL EMAIL AND ETIQUETTE GUIDE:

For this task I drafted two professional emails and created a social media do's and don'ts checklist.

The first email was a request to a professor for an assignment deadline extension. The second was an expression of interest in a summer internship opportunity at a company. Both emails follow professional email structure — a clear subject line, formal greeting, well structured body, and proper sign-off.

Before this task I never thought carefully about how I write emails. I realized that the way I message friends on WhatsApp short, casual, no greeting is completely inappropriate in a professional setting. A poorly written email to a professor or recruiter can create a negative impression even if the request itself is genuine.

I also created a social media checklist with five do's and five don'ts for college students. One thing that stood out to me while making it was how often students post things without thinking about long term consequences. Unlike a conversation, a social media post is permanent and can affect future opportunities.

This task changed how I think about digital communication. I now understand that professional communication is not just about what you say — it is about how you say it.

TASK 5 — CYBERCRIME AWARENESS

For this task I researched UPI Payment Fraud and created a case study and prevention checklist.

UPI fraud works by tricking victims into entering their PIN on a "collect request" which looks like a receive money notification but is actually a payment approval. The attacker pretends to be a bank official or buyer and creates urgency to prevent the victim from thinking carefully.

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how easily educated people fall for these scams. I always assumed only elderly or uneducated people get scammed. But the reality is that anyone can be tricked when they are excited about an opportunity or acting quickly under pressure. This is exactly what makes UPI fraud so effective.

I also created a prevention checklist with ten actionable tips including two specific to UPI and financial safety. The most important tip I learned is that you should never need to enter your PIN to receive money — if someone asks you to do that, it is always a scam.

One habit I will personally change after this task is to always verify the sender's details before responding to any message that creates urgency or asks for sensitive information. I realized I have received suspicious messages before and almost clicked on links without thinking.

CONCULSION

TASK 1: INFOGRAPHIC

I created a Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using Canva covering what digital literacy is, safe internet practices, useful digital tools, email etiquette, and professional online presence. This task taught me that a well designed visual can communicate complex information more effectively than paragraphs of text. I also learned basic design principles like color consistency and layout balance.

TASK 2: DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

I set up professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle. I created a GitHub profile README showcasing my learning goals and current skills. I filled my LinkedIn education section with my B.Tech details. Starting these profiles in first year means recruiters will see four years of genuine growth rather than a profile created in panic before placements.

TASK 3: PLATFORMS

I completed multiple Python challenges on HackerRank and built a five question Digital Literacy Quiz on Google Forms linked to a Google Sheet. I discovered that Google Forms can collect and organize responses from hundreds of people automatically without any coding. HackerRank helped me understand how companies evaluate coding skills objectively

TASK 4: EMAIL ETIQUETTE

I drafted two professional emails and created a social media checklist. Before this task I never thought carefully about email structure. I realized that the casual style I use on WhatsApp is completely inappropriate in professional settings. A poorly written email to a professor or recruiter creates a negative impression even if the request itself is genuine and well intentioned.

TASK 5: CYBERCRIME

I researched UPI Payment Fraud in depth and created a detailed case study and prevention checklist. What shocked me most was that educated and aware people still fall for scams when they act quickly under pressure. I learned that cybersecurity is not just about knowing the risks — it is about building daily habits of verifying before trusting any digital communication.

REFRENCES

- CANVA — CANVA.COM
- GITHUB — GITHUB.COM
- LINKEDIN — LINKEDIN.COM
- KAGGLE — KAGGLE.COM
- HACKERRANK — HACKERRANK.COM
- GOOGLE FORMS — FORMS.GOOGLE.COM
- NATIONAL CYBER CRIME PORTAL — CYBERCRIME.GOV.IN
- CYBER CRIME HELPLINE — 1930
- CERT-IN CYBER SAFETY GUIDELINES — CERT-IN.ORG.IN
- UNESCO DIGITAL LITERACY FRAMEWORK — UNESCO.OR